Microsoft outage hits Outlook and Teams

Outlook, Teams and Copilot stopped working for thousands of people on Thursday. Microsoft says that some of its servers went offline.

Level 2 · B1 · 247 words · 10.7 words per sentence · 9 glossed · Print PDF

On Thursday, November 12, many people could not open their work email. A Microsoft outage hit Outlook, Teams, Copilot and other Microsoft 365 services. The company said that users in any region could be affected.

The site Downdetector collects complaints from users. It showed about 130,000 reports about Outlook shortly after 1 p.m. Eastern Time. Just before 3 p.m., the number had fallen to about 77,000. Some people said their emails were not being sent or received, and others could not open their inboxes.

Microsoft explained that some of its servers were not available. They were failing automatic health checks, and this put pressure on the servers that were still working. The company said it was working to bring the servers back safely. It did not say when everything would be normal again.

The problem also affected the connectors that AI services, such as those from OpenAI and Anthropic, use to reach Microsoft 365 accounts.

Earlier in the day, a separate problem with Teams had been fixed. In the afternoon, Microsoft said that its latest fix was showing signs of success, and it began to use the fix more widely.

So far, Microsoft has not said that the outage was a cyberattack, and no hacker group has said it was responsible. The reports do not yet explain why the servers failed.

Why does it matter? Many companies depend on a few cloud services for email, meetings and files. When one of them stops, work stops for many people at the same time.

GLOSSARY

outage	queda de um serviço, interrupção
Downdetector	site onde usuários avisam quando um serviço está fora do ar
inboxes	caixas de entrada
servers	servidores
health checks	testes automáticos que mostram se um servidor funciona bem
connectors	conectores, ligações entre programas
fix	correção, solução
cyberattack	ataque hacker
cloud services	serviços na nuvem, programas que rodam em servidores da empresa e são acessados pela internet

THE DAY, IN EASTERN TIME

Morning	A separate problem with Teams in North America is fixed.
Early afternoon	Reports about Outlook on Downdetector climb to about 130,000.
Before 3 p.m.	The number falls to about 77,000, but problems continue.
Afternoon	Microsoft says its latest fix shows signs of success and starts to use it more broadly.

Sources: Al Jazeera, Reuters, ABC News, Techaeris. The times are the ones in the reports.

What we know, and what we do not

The story was still developing on the evening of November 12. This table keeps what the reports confirm apart from what is still open.

	CONFIRMED	NOT KNOWN YET
WHAT BROKE	Outlook mailboxes (Exchange Online), Teams, SharePoint, Copilot and other Microsoft 365 services had problems.	How many people were affected in total. Downdetector counts only the reports that users send.
THE NUMBERS	Reports about Outlook reached about 130,000 shortly after 1 p.m. Eastern Time and fell to about 77,000 before 3 p.m.	The real number of users who lost access.
MICROSOFT'S EXPLANATION	Some servers went offline and failed their automatic health checks. That put pressure on the servers still working.	What made the servers fail in the first place.
A CYBERATTACK?	Microsoft has not said it was an attack, and no hacker group has claimed it.	Whether the cause was a technical failure or something else.
THE FIX	Microsoft restarted affected servers and said its latest fix showed signs of working.	When every service will be back to normal.
AI SERVICES	The connectors that OpenAI's and Anthropic's services use to reach Microsoft 365 accounts were also hit.	How long those connections were down.

Sources: Al Jazeera, Reuters, BleepingComputer, ABC News, Techaeris. Situation on the evening of November 12, 2026.

WORDS IN THIS TABLE AND IN THE KEY DATES

Exchange Online serviço de e-mail da Microsoft para empresas

AFTER READING

1. What stopped working on Thursday, and who was affected?
2. What did Microsoft say about the problem?
3. What do we not know yet?

TALK ABOUT IT

4. What do you do when your email or video calls stop working at work?
5. Many companies use only a few big cloud services. Is that a good idea? Why or why not?
6. What should a company tell its customers during an outage?
7. Do you use AI tools at work? What would happen if they stopped working for a whole day?

SOURCES

Al Jazeera, Microsoft outage hits tens of thousands of users

Reuters (via MarketScreener), Microsoft 365, Outlook down for thousands of US users, Downdetector shows

BleepingComputer, Massive Microsoft 365 outage disrupts Outlook, Teams, Copilot worldwide

ABC News, Outlook outage: Microsoft reports 'issues' with Teams and email

Techaeris, Microsoft 365 Outage Takes Down Outlook, Teams and Copilot